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Julia Barr - 11:45 AM EDT - July 21, 2025

IMAGE CREDITS: iStock

gma began trading on the New York Stock Exchange on Thursday after a long delay. It soared so quickly that trading was halted for a short time due to market volatility.

Within a minute of trading, its market cap hit \$45 billion but the price spent the day bouncing between \$101 and as high as \$124. It closed at \$115.50 and a \$47 billion market cap, Yahoo Finance reports.

The company and existing investors sold shares at the IPO price of \$33 per share. Quite the pop. And after-market trading is still hot with the stock price climbing.

There has been so much demand for this stock that people on X were posting funny pictures of their orders being fulfilled by Robinhood. Instead of getting dozens or hundreds of shares as requested, they were allocated one sold. One person wanted 100 shares and ended up getting 17 shares.

In any case, the stock's acquisition by Coinbase is a footnote in its history.

Topics: [Elon Musk](#) [Tesla](#)

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 **Julie Bort**
Venture Editor [@JBort](#)

Julie Bort is the Startups/Venture Desk editor for TechCrunch.

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KEEP READING

Tesla shuts down Dojo, the AI training supercomputer that Musk said would be key to full



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the same chip," Musk said.

The news comes as Tesla's board offers Musk a \$29 billion pay package to keep him at Tesla and help push the company's AI efforts forward, rather than getting too sidetracked by his other companies, including the more pure-play AI startup xAI.

TechCrunch has reached out to Tesla for more information.

Have a sensitive tip or confidential documents? We're reporting on the inner workings of the AI industry — from the companies shaping its future to the people impacted by their decisions. Reach out to Rebecca Bellan at rebecca.bellan@techcrunch.com and Maxwell Zeff at maxwell.zeff@techcrunch.com. For secure communication, you can contact us via Signal at [@rebeccabellan.491](#) and [@mzeff.88](#).

Topics: AI, automation

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Rebecca Bellan
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Rebecca Bellan is a senior reporter at TechCrunch where she covers the business, policy, and emerging trends shaping artificial intelligence. Her work has also...

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Rocket Lab eyes big defense opportunities with new acquisition

Ana Alameludesai • 1:23 PM PDT • August 7, 2025



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Rocket Lab's second quarter revenues continued to grow more than launch. The company's strategy and how it will make it more competitive.

The company's second quarter revenue, its highest since 2021, rose 36% from a year earlier.

Rocket Lab founder Peter Beck said the company's "M&A activity" as the company that built the

will close at \$275 million in cash and equity. Rocket Lab is opening a new business unit called Optical Systems to scale electro-optical and infrared sensor manufacturing.

Those sensors are used in missile warning, tracking, and space domain awareness. The acquisition is also one part of a larger play from Rocket Lab — spelled out quite explicitly in the company's earnings presentation — to bid for multibillion-dollar DOD initiatives like Golden Dome.

Rocket Lab has already won some major defense contracts, including a \$515 million, 18-satellite build contract to support the Space Development Agency's constellation of missile-tracking satellites. The company has moved into production on those satellites, following

Rocket Lab eyes big defense opportunities with new acquisition

Ana Alameludesai

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Ana Alameludesai

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confirmation that they meet all DOD's mission requirements, Rocket Lab said.

Aria Alemahodaei
- 16 hrs ago

Down on Earth, Rocket Lab says it's progressing well toward the first launch of its larger Neutron rocket. The rocket's launch complex in Virginia is expected to be complete in the third quarter of this year, with hardware en route and the new rocket engine, called Archimedes, undergoing multiple tests per day.

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This is due to the high costs of using large language models (LLMs), the person explained. AI coding assistants are particularly pressured to always offer the most recent, most advanced, and most expensive LLMs because model makers are particularly fine-tuning their latest models for improvements in coding and related tasks like debugging.

This is a challenge compounded by fierce competition in the vibe-coding and code-assist market. Rivals include companies that already have huge customer bases like Anysphere's Cursor and GitHub Copilot.

The most straightforward path to improving margins in this business involves the startups building their own models, thereby eliminating costs of paying suppliers like Anthropic and OpenAI.

"It's a very expensive business to run if you're not going to be in the model game," said



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But that idea came from Varun Mohan, ultimately a model — an exper

In addition, model offers Claude Cod

Selling the business was a strategic move to lock in a high return before it could be undermined by the very companies that supplied its AI, including OpenAI and Anthropic, which were also entering the AI coding market.

Multiple people believe that the same pressure on margins Windsurf faced could be impacting Anysphere, the maker of Cursor, as well as vibe coders like Lovable, Replit, and others.

"Margins on all of the 'code gen' products are either neutral or negative. They're absolutely abysmal," said Nicholas Charriere, founder of Mocha, a vibe-coding startup and back-end hosting solution serving small and medium businesses (SMBs). He added that he believes the variable

costs for all the startups in the sector are very close, likely within 10% to

Most startups will not have a lawyer

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partner at Google
expensive it's even

It's not entirely clear
cost of some of the
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When that will change
OpenAI introduced
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Anysphere has also
the increased cost
particularly to its
customers by sur
top of its \$20-per
apologized for un
blog post.

This is the rock an

popular AI applications, having reached \$500 million in ARR in June, the
company's user base may not be so loyal to the product if another
company develops a tool that is superior to Cursor, investors say.

Anysphere didn't respond to a request for comment.

Given the competitive landscape and the costs, Windsurf's decision to
get out may prove to be understandable. After the OpenAI deal fell
through, the founders and key employees left to join Google in a deal
that led to a \$2.4 billion payout to key shareholders. The remaining
business then sold itself to Cognition.

While many, including prominent VCs, criticized Mohan for leaving
approximately 200 employees without roles at Google, a source familiar

with the deal insisted the acquisition actually maximized the outcomes for all employees.

Beyond Cursor, other AI coding tools are also among the fastest growing startups of the LLM generation, like Replit, Lovable, and Bolt, and all of them rely on model makers as well.

Additionally, if this extremely popular business sector, already generating hundreds of millions in revenue or more a year, has difficulty building on top of model makers, what might it mean for other, more nascent industries?

Topics: [AI](#) [coding assistants](#) [cursor](#) [Startups](#) [Venture](#) [Windsurf](#)



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How to use Instagram Map and set your location-sharing preferences

This week, Instagram introduced a new Snap Map feature, an Instagram Map that lets U.S. users share their most recent active location with others and discover location-based content.

If you decide to turn on your location on Instagram Map, your location only updates when you open the app or have it running in the background, meaning it doesn't provide continuous, real-time location updates. This is different from Snap Map, which lets users choose whether their location is updated only when they open the app or in real time.

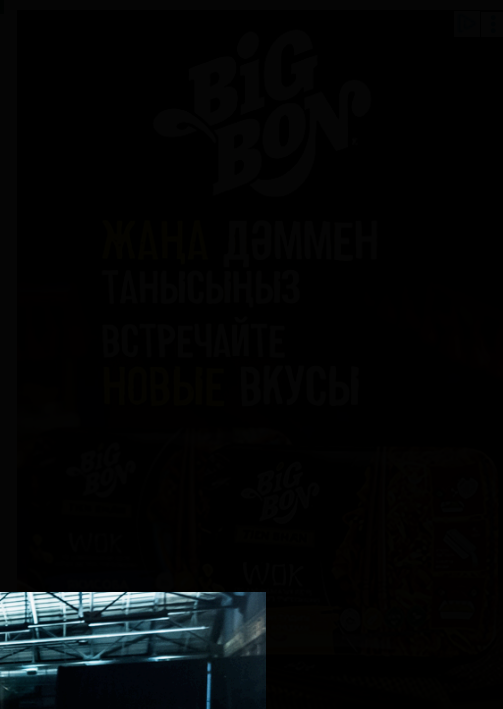
Meta says location sharing is off by default on Instagram Map. Following concerns around safety, Instagram head Adam Mosseri reassured users that the feature is opt-in, and noted that some people are "confused" about how the feature works.

For instance, people populated with the feature automatically in Stories or Reels tr

It's worth noting that tags visible to use the feature makes this might make you n with location tags

For those who want Map, we'll walk you

How to ac



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IMAGE COURTESY OF

The first time you turn on location sharing, you'll see a pop-up that says, "You are not sharing your location." From there, you can choose to share your location with your friends (followers you follow back) or with everyone.

To change your privacy settings, go to the "Settings" option in the app. Under the "Location" option, you'll be able to choose whether you want to share your location with your friends or with everyone.

Note that if you have location sharing turned off, others can still share their location with you, which means you'll be able to see them on the Map.

How to use Instagram Map

When you open the app, you will see the locations of friends who have shared their location with you. You will also see location-based Stories and Reels from people you follow.

For example, if your friend attended a nearby music festival and posted a story while there, it will appear on the map. Similarly, if a creator you follow posts a Reel about a new restaurant, it will appear on the map.

Follow posts a reel about a new restaurant in your city, you'll be able to discover it on Instagram Map.

You will still see location-based content on the Map even if you have your location turned off.

You also can leave short, ephemeral messages, or "Notes," on the map for others to see. Instagram Notes are the short messages that currently appear at the top of your direct messaging feed, but with the launch of Instagram Map, you will now see these posts on the map if they're shared with a location.

Topics: [Apps](#) [Instagram](#) [Instagram map](#) [Snap Map](#) [Social](#)



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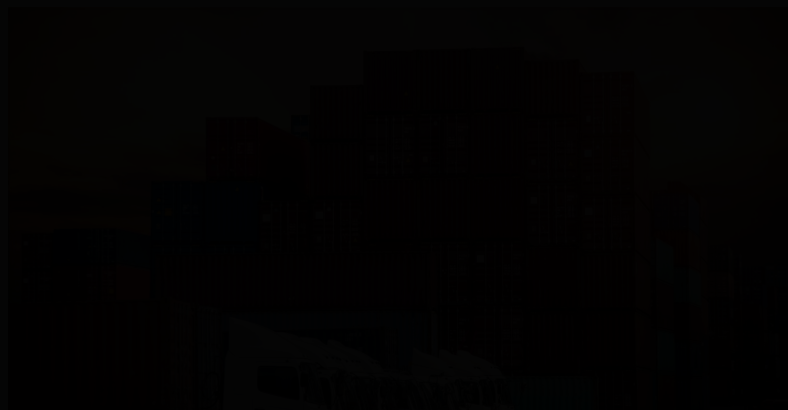


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